

The Noticing Game

A gentle week of self-discovery — no tests, no scores, no right answers.

The idea in one line: instead of asking a young person "what are you good at?" (a question almost no 13-year-old can answer honestly), you spend a week quietly **noticing** their real days — and let the patterns reveal themselves.

How it works: Each evening, your daughter answers three short questions about that day. Two lines each is plenty. There are no wrong answers, and nobody is graded. At the end of the week, the two of you look back together — and that's where the magic is: *she* spots the patterns, you don't tell her what they are.

The three rules: (1) Honesty over impressiveness. (2) No judging the answers — yours or hers. (3) If a day gets missed, skip it, don't catch up. This is a game, not homework.

The three daily questions

1 What made me lose track of time today?

A moment where I looked up and time had flown.

Why this one: deep focus is the single clearest signal of natural pull. We chase what absorbs us.

2 What drained me or made me want to leave the room?

Something I dreaded, avoided, or felt relieved to finish.

Why this one: knowing what empties your battery is as useful as knowing what fills it — and far kinder than calling it a "weakness."

3 What did someone come to me for, or thank me for?

A small moment where I was the helpful, trusted, or go-to person.

Why this one: other people often see our strengths before we do. This catches them in the wild.

Tip for the parent: don't react to the answers during the week — no praise, no fixing, no "you should do more of that." Just collect. Reactions change what she writes next.

FILL ONE ROW EACH EVENING

My week of noticing

Day	Lost track of time	Drained me	Came to me / thanked me
Mon	write here...		
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			

Print this page, or copy the three columns into a notebook. Phone notes work too — paper just makes the end-of-week look-back easier to spread out.

How to read the patterns

On the weekend, sit together with the filled sheet. Your job is not to analyse her — it's to ask questions that help **her** notice. Read the week aloud, column by column, then explore:

Look for repetition, not big moments. The same kind of thing showing up three times matters more than one dramatic day. "Helping a friend understand math" appearing twice is a real signal.

Translate activities into ingredients. Don't stop at "I liked drawing." Ask: was it the *making*, the *colours*, the *quiet*, the *showing-someone-after*? The ingredient repeats across many activities; the activity won't.

Treat "drained me" gently. Frame it as *"so that's something that costs you a lot of energy"* — never *"so you're bad at that."* The goal is self-knowledge, not a list of flaws.

Let her name it. End with: *"If you had to describe the shape of your week in one sentence, what would it be?"* Whatever she says — that's the first sentence of her self-understanding. Don't correct it.

Three questions to ask out loud

- "Which of these days would you happily live again tomorrow?"
- "What surprised you about your own week?"
- "Is there something here you'd want to do more of — even just a little?"

What success looks like

Not a label. Not a career. Success is a single moment where she says *"huh — I didn't realise I do that"* and looks a little more curious about herself than she did a week ago. If you get that, the experiment worked, and you repeat it next month with fresh eyes.

*This is Phase 1 of three: **Self-awareness** (this week) → **Confidence** (reflecting her patterns back as strengths) → **Direction** (much later, connecting what energises her to kinds of activities and fields, never a single career). Don't rush ahead — the evidence she builds now is what makes the later phases honest.*